

Your own Private Eye

Looking for a security device? Use your Web cam to build your own security and motion detection system. A webcam coupled with a software capable of detecting the movements and raising an alarm based on movement can prove a worthy security system. Download motion detection software like Gotcha and Inetcam from www.gotchanow.com or www.inetcam.com.

After you have installed Gotcha and launched the software, select Properties from the Options menu. Click on the

Detection tab in the window that pops up. By default, Gotcha is set to capture one frame for every 5 minutes. You can choose to set the time frame according to your needs. Once you have set all the other options, click on the Observe button on the tool bar (the small button with an eye on it). Gotcha starts monitoring your area of interest through the eyes of your camera. You can choose to e-mail the images to your mailbox and also raise an alarm in case an actual intrusion is detected. The sensitivity of detection can be set in the Detection Properties option.

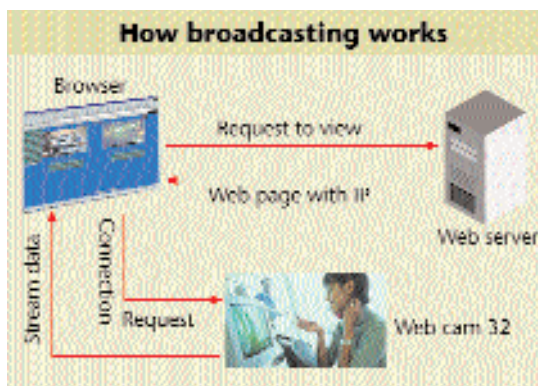
with a permanent connection to the Internet.

When you connect to your ISP through a dial-up connection, your computer is assigned an IP and the IP changes each time you connect. Now a Web cam viewer connects to your streaming video service through the IP entry available on your Web page. Since the IP changes every time you reconnect on a dial-up, does it mean you have to change the IP entry on your page every time manually? Not in the least. Webcam32 has a solution. Make a standard page with an entry such as `<IMG SRC=http://%%IP%%:8888/video/frame>` locally on your hard disk. From the File menu choose Preferences. There choose **FTP > IP Upload**. On the right hand side enter the path of the file with the above-mentioned entry. Check the appropriate boxes below, which state whether to upload pages while Webcam32 starts up or to upload it when the software detects an IP change.

Once you are done with the settings, connect to the Internet by dialling your ISP number. Once the PC connects to the Internet, it's assigned a new IP. Webcam32 reads this new IP address and replaces the '%IP%' entry in the above HTML image tag and uploads the page to your site.

There are several other uses you can put a Web cam to. As you become more comfortable with the operation and handling of this device, you will find more to do with it. 

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Live streaming using Webcam32

bandwidth is consumed and a connection established with the Webcam32 software for each client connected to your camera. The transmission of the image should however be stopped at some point of time to avoid network hogging. Webcam32 has a configurable option using which you can terminate the connection with a browser after a particular time frame or after delivering defined kilobits of data, whichever comes first.

You need to spend some time configuring the TCP/IP settings in the Webcam32 software. To do this, go to **File > Preferences** and choose the TCP/IP option on the left. In the features subsection, make sure all options are enabled

except RCM Control. Thereafter, choose the Access tab, enter the Remote Access Port, and in the server push tab, enter appropriate push interval and size. You are done.

What about dial-up users?

All that we have stated before works perfectly for someone using a fixed IP computer

Web cam Options in India

Creative Webcam CLA USB

Price: Rs 2,600

Contact: Compuage Infocom

E-mail: info@compuageindia.com

D-Link - DSB c300

Price: Rs 3,500

Contact: D-Link India

E-mail: sseghal@link-india.com

Logitech Clicksmart

Price: Rs 8,000

Contact: Rashi Peripherals

E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com

The other options

A cheaper alternative always exists. People who just want to have a feel of the Web cam without spending too much can try various Taiwanese and Chinese models that can be found in computer hardware shops.

Typhoon (Easy Web cam): Rs 1,650

Rookie: Rs 1,800

Dialbox Arisoo: Rs 3,000